Checkerspot

Company Overview Checkerspot is a California-based materials science company that "designs" new materials using microalgae. They are best known for their brand "WNDR Alpine," which creates high-performance skis and outdoor gear using algae-based materials instead of petroleum-based plastics.



INFANT NUTRITION

Packed with essential lipids and nutrients, our algae derived ingredients provide versatile, scalable solutions for enhanced nutrition



FUNCTIONAL FOOD

Our tailored fats deliver the functionality of traditional animal and tropical fats, offering sustainable, plant-based alternatives without compromising performance.



SUPPLEMENTS

We produce high-value, bioavailable oils designed to support health and human development at every stage of life.



PERSONAL CARE

Algal oils designed to deliver superior functional performance to support the next generation of personal care and cosmetic formulations.

ESG Focus: Algae-Based Polyurethanes (Microalgae Materials)

Why (The Problem) Most outdoor gear (like skis, jackets, and boots) is made from plastics and foams derived from crude oil. These materials are difficult to recycle, and their production releases a lot of CO2. Furthermore, petroleum-based plastics often don't have the best performance for extreme sports.

How (The Solution) Checkerspot uses microalgae as "tiny factories." They feed the algae sugars, and the algae naturally produce high-quality oils. The company then uses these oils to create "Bio-Polyurethanes"—a type of sustainable plastic. These materials are specifically designed to be light, strong, and damp (which is great for absorbing vibrations in skis).

What (The Outcome) This creates "Molecularly Engineered" gear. By using algae instead of oil, the company reduces the carbon footprint of manufacturing. Their products are not only better for the planet but often perform better than traditional plastic gear because they can control the material's properties at a molecular level.

Impact: Checkerspot is proving that sustainable materials can outperform traditional ones in high-stakes industries like sports and aerospace. They are working to expand their algae-based materials into the beauty and textile industries to replace harmful synthetic chemicals.